WEEK 7: PRACTICAL EXERCISES WITH GENERAL AND SPECIALISED CLASSIFICATION SCHEMES (DDC, LCC, AND MOYS)

1. Introduction

This week focuses on the **practical application** of classification principles using both general and specialised schemes.
While theoretical understanding is important, library professionals must also be able to **assign correct class numbers**, **construct call marks**, and **interpret schedules**.
In this lesson, we shall conduct simple practical exercises using the following:

* **Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC)** – general scheme

* **Library of Congress Classification (LCC)** – general scheme

* **Moys Classification Scheme for Law** – specialised scheme

These are the most commonly used schemes in Nigerian academic and research libraries.

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2. Practical Exercises Using the Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC)

Recap of DDC Structure

DDC divides knowledge into **ten main classes (000–900)**.

Each class is further divided into **ten divisions**, and each division into **ten sections**.

The structure is **hierarchical** — meaning general subjects come before specific ones.

Steps in Classifying a Book Using DDC

Examine the Book or Material:
Study the title page, introduction, and table of contents to determine the subject matter.

Identify the Main Subject:
Decide the dominant topic of the work.

Consult the DDC Schedule:
Look up the subject in the main schedule or through the relative index.

Select the Correct Class Number:
Choose the most appropriate number that represents the subject.

Add Standard Subdivisions (if necessary):
Use **Table 1** to add details like form, geography, or language.

Construct the Call Mark:
Combine the class number with the **author mark** and **book number**.

Example 1 (DDC Practical Exercise)

Title: *Introduction to Psychology*
Subject: Psychology
Main Class: 100 – Philosophy and Psychology
Division: 150 – Psychology
Section: 150.1 – General Works on Psychology

Class Number: 150
Author Mark (e.g., Ade – from Cutter Table): A24
Call Mark: 150 A24

Example 2

Title: *African Agricultural Practices*
Subject: Agriculture in Africa
Main Class: 600 – Technology
Division: 630 – Agriculture
Section: 631 – Techniques, Equipment, Materials
Standard Subdivision (Geographic – Africa): .096
Class Number: 631.096
Author Mark: B37
Call Mark: 631.096 B37

Example 3

Title: *History of Christianity in Nigeria*
Subject: Christianity – History – Nigeria
Main Class: 200 – Religion
Division: 270 – History, Geography, Persons in Christianity
Section: 276 – Africa
Standard Subdivision (Nigeria): .669
Class Number: 276.669
Author Mark: O45
Call Mark: 276.669 O45

3. Practical Exercises Using the Library of Congress Classification (LCC)

Recap of LCC Structure

LCC uses **letters and numbers (alphanumeric)**.

There are **21 main classes**, each represented by one or two letters.

Example:

Q = Science

QA = Mathematics

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QA76 = Computer Science

3.2 Steps in Classifying a Book Using LCC

Identify the Subject: Determine what the book is about.

Consult the LCC Schedule: Locate the class and subclass letters.

Determine the Subject Number: Select the correct number under the subclass.

Add Cutter Number: Represent the author or title using the Cutter table.

Include Year of Publication: Often added to distinguish editions.

Example 1 (LCC Practical Exercise)

Title: *Principles of Economics*
Subject: Economics
Main Class: H – Social Sciences
Subclass: HB – Economic Theory
Number: HB171.5
Author Mark (Ade): A34
Year: 2020

Call Mark: HB171.5 .A34 2020

Example 2

Title: *Introduction to Library and Information Science*
Subject: Library Science
Main Class: Z – Bibliography, Library Science
Subclass: Z665 – Library Science (General Works)
Author Mark: O55
Year: 2021

Call Mark: Z665 .O55 2021

Example 3

Title: *Artificial Intelligence in Education*
Subject: AI Application in Education
Main Class: Q – Science
Subclass: QA – Mathematics, Computer Science
Number: QA76.9.A43 (Artificial Intelligence)
Additional Subdivision (Education): Add E38
Author Mark: S35
Call Mark: QA76.9.A43 S35 2022

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4. Practical Exercise Using a Specialised Scheme – Moys Classification Scheme for Law

Background

The **Moys Classification Scheme for Law** was developed by **Elizabeth Moys** in **1968** to meet the specific needs of law libraries.
It is used widely in law schools, legal research institutions, and courts in Nigeria.

The scheme combines features of both DDC and LCC but provides more detailed treatment of legal subjects.

Structure of the Moys Scheme

The Moys scheme uses **letters and numbers**, like the LCC.
It covers:

Jurisprudence

International Law

Constitutional Law

Criminal Law

Administrative Law

Property Law, etc.

Example of Main Classes in Moys:

Main Class	Subject
K	Law (General)
KA	Jurisprudence and General Theory of Law
KB	Comparative Law
KC	International Law
KD	Religious Legal Systems
KE	Commonwealth Law
KF	Law of England and Wales
KG	Law of Canada
KH	Law of Africa
KL	Law of Nigeria

Example 1 (Moys Practical Exercise)

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Title: *Nigerian Constitutional Law*
Subject: Nigerian Law – Constitution
Main Class: KL – Law of Nigeria
Subdivision: KL34 – Constitutional Law
Author Mark: A45
Year: 2021

Call Mark: KL34 .A45 2021

Example 2

Title: *Criminal Procedure in Nigeria*
Subject: Criminal Law
Main Class: KL – Law of Nigeria
Subdivision: KL500 – Criminal Procedure
Author Mark: O78
Year: 2022

Call Mark: KL500 .O78 2022

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Importance of Practical Classification

Practical exercises in classification are essential because they:

1. Develop accuracy and consistency in assigning class numbers.
2. Help students understand the *logic behind subject arrangement*.
3. Prepare future cataloguers and indexers for real-life library operations.
4. Bridge the gap between theory and practice.

Summary

In this week's lecture, we applied the principles of classification using three schemes — **DDC, LCC, and Moys**.
Each scheme follows a different structure and notation system, yet all serve the same purpose: **to organise and retrieve knowledge effectively.**
DDC uses numerical hierarchy, LCC employs alphanumeric precision, and Moys provides special treatment for legal materials.

A good classifier must understand not just the rules but also the *context* and *content* of each resource.

Assignment

Using LCC, classify:

1. Introduction to Sociology
2. Computer Programming for Beginners
3. Tourism in Nigeria
4. Principles of Marketing
5. Introduction to Political Science

Construct complete call marks for two of your examples above.

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